UPFRONT

COLUMN: TRUMP RAISES N-STAKES *PG 10*

GRAPHIC: ANIL AMBANI UNDER ED FIRE *PG 12*



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FIRING RANGE Rahul Gandhi at the press meet in Delhi, Nov. 5

▶ HARYANA POLL FRAUD

H-BOMB OR FIRECRACKER?

Rahul Gandhi presents 'explosive' evidence of vote *chori* in Haryana, accuses ECI of collusion. They ask why now, and not before polls

By KAUSHIK DEKA

ON NOVEMBER 5, AT THE CONGRESS HEADQUARTERS IN NEW DELHI, Leader of the Opposition Rahul Gandhi faced the national press with an explosive charge: Indian democracy, he declared, had been "stolen". Citing thousands of pages of voter data, Rahul alleged that the BJP had turned a widely predicted Congress victory in the 2024 Haryana assembly poll into defeat through a "centralised operation" involving fake, duplicate and deleted voters. The Election Commission of India (ECI), he contended, had acted in concert with the ruling BJP, enabling a "systematic theft of democracy".

THE HARYANA DOSSIER

The core claim: approximately 2.5 million of Haryana's 20 million voters, or 12.5 per cent of the electorate, were compromised. Despite exit polls predicting 54-62 seats for the Congress, the party lost by 118,000 votes statewide and